



Discussion Guide: Doug Shipman

Is Reconciliation Right for America?

Reflect

- Describe a circumstance in which you have experienced reconciliation in a personal relationship. What stood in the way of that relationship being restored and how did you and the other person overcome those obstacles?
- One of the central issues in discussing racial reconciliation in general is that people confuse blame and responsibility. What is the difference between something being your fault and something being your responsibility? When have you felt responsible to make a situation right or better even though the problem itself was not your doing?

Respond

- In your perspective, what would racial reconciliation look like in your own community or church? What do you think stands in the way of such reconciliation happening?
- Are there circumstances where you think reconciliation is not something we should strive for? If so, what is it about those circumstances that makes you think reconciliation is not (yet) the goal?
- Consider the Apostle Paul's instructions to the early Christian community: "All this is from God, who reconciled us to himself through Christ and has given us the ministry of reconciliation; that is, in Christ God was reconciling the world to himself, not counting their trespasses against them, and entrusting the message of reconciliation to us" (2 Cor 5:18-19). What role do you think the church can play in bringing about racial and political reconciliation in our world today?

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